NewsChain

A news app that starts from the outcome and rewinds time to reveal the full story.

Team members:

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Led by Sho Ogawa

- # Introduction

- Describe the App

  NewsChain is a narrative-driven news app that helps users understand current events by starting from the present outcome and rewinding through past events to explain how and why the news happened. It presents news as connected stories, encouraging deeper understanding and critical thinking while helping users detect misinformation.

- How Is It Novel?

  Unlike traditional news apps that prioritize the latest headlines, NewsChain reverses the timeline of news consumption. By beginning with the outcome and guiding users backward through relevant context, the app promotes deeper understanding and reduces surface-level or reactionary news consumption.

- Transformative Experience for the User

  The user can feel grounded and focused by seeing the present event as a single, clear moment of significance. In addition, they can experience a sense of discovery as they uncover past stories that led to the present news. In this way, news consumption becomes narrative-driven, and the user can become an active thinker by seeing entire events as a connected chain. Furthermore, the user can become a well-informed individual who understands the news deeply and is able to detect misinformation

- Motto for your app

  Starting with the outcome, trace back to the cause.

- # Background Research

- Market Competitor Apps
  - Apple News
  - Google News
  - BBC News App
  - The New York Times App

- What are the market inspiration apps
  - Wikipedia

    → how complex events can be understood through linked historical context
  - Notion / Knowledge Graph Tools

    → See information as connected nodes instead of linear feeds.

- PACT framework

  People

  Students, young people and ordinary readers who want to understand current news deeply.

  Activity

  Users check current news from the outcome, and then trace past events

  Context

  The app is used when commuting, taking short breaks, and studying. Users often are in this kind of situation, so they might be distracted or limited by something in the middle of reading news. That's

why news apps provide should be short, clear, and easy to navigate.

Technology

Newschain is designed as a mobile app. It requires timeline-based navigation, source aggregation, and data visualization for connecting event chains.

- Value Proposition

  These apps provide a new kind of experience for users who want to understand current events deeply. Compared to traditional news apps like Apple News and Google News, NewsChain starts with the outcome of an event and rewinds through past events to reveal cause-and-effect relationships. This process enhances users' critical thinking and helps them detect and avoid misinformation. By combining timeline-based navigation with clear summaries and visualized connections, NewsChain makes news understandable and easily consumable within a limited time.

- Project Contract for NewsChain

  I, Sho Ogawa, will be responsible for all roles and parts and agree to this contract.

- Optional Preliminary list of features
  - Timeline-based news navigation
  - Cause-and-effect mapping
  - Summarized key points
  - Source comparison
  - Highlight misinformation indicators
  - Interactive exploration
  - Personalized learning path

- AI Use Section

AI Tool Name	Version, Account Type	Specific feature for which the AI tool was used
ChatGPT mini-5	Free account	Searching market competitor app and other unique features

- value Addition

  Come up with most part of app features to provide unique experience for users with AI's info

- Appendix: Prompt History

2026-02-01
ChatGPT (GPT-5-mini)
"Explain Background Research: competitor apps and inspiration apps for NewsChain."
Listed Apple News, Google News, Wikipedia, Vox, etc., and their influence.

- Work Date/Hours logs for student

Date	Number of Hours	Description of work done
Feb, 1, 2026	6	Wiriting summary of producition proposal